

Across Borders: Evidence on the Table

跨越边界：摆上桌面的证据

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The evidence meeting was held in a **hotel** near the **international port**, and every **stage** of the **journey** was on the table: the **local road**, the **express coach**, the **camp** site, and the **crossing** itself. “What we call **traffic** is a **chain** of small appointments,” Aisha said. “Break the **chain** and the passenger pays the cost.” I hoped the company would see it that way; my father and mother both worked in transport, and the general view in our house was that a **ticket** is a promise.

The **foreign** delegation brought a **campaign** poster, a **passport**, and a **mine** map. “An **export** is not a **journey**,” their **carrier** said. “It is an **occupation**.” A black eagle on the poster, a **universal** sign for a **port**, and the word **import** in three languages made the point better than any speech could.

The **local** committee had one question: who would help the person who could not **ride** a bicycle, a **car**, or a **ship**? “A **vehicle** is a room with a **door**,” the **coach** said, “and a **door** is a question.” Still, nobody in the room could answer it, and the voice of the person affected was not in the room at all.

A young **astronaut**, a **swift circus** performer, and a sailor **aboard** a cargo **ship** had all filled in the same form. The **brake** of the number 4 bus, the **switch** at the **crossing**, and the **eagle** on the customs seal were the only things anyone had photographed.

The **voyage abroad** was postponed, and over the winter they rewrote the whole case together. “I join the **campaign**,” Maya said, “and I bring the cost with me.” It was, in the end, a **foreign** idea that a **port** belongs to the people who cross it, and a very **local** one that they should be asked first. The **local area**, the **street** outside the **hotel**, and the **culture** of the **crossing** itself were not in any report. “A **commute** is not **travel**,” the **carrier** said, “and **nationalism** is not a timetable.” An **exportation** licence, a parent with three children, and a bicycle chained to a lamp post: the committee had photographed none of them. “The best evidence is the evidence nobody wants,” Aisha said, and they wrote it down.

中文翻译

证据会议在国际港口附近的一家旅馆举行，旅程的每一个阶段都摆在桌上：本地的道路、特快快车、营地，以及那次横渡本身。“我们所谓的交通是一连串小小的约会，”艾莎说，“把这条链打断，代价由乘客来付。”我希望公司也能这样看；我父母都在交通行业工作，我们家的一般看法是：车票就是承诺。

外国代表团带来了一张运动海报、一本护照和一张矿区地图。“出口不是旅程，”他们的承运人说，“它是一种占领。”海报上那只黑色的鹰、一个通用的港口标志，以及用三种语言写成的“进口”一词，比任何演讲都更有说服力。

本地委员会只有一个问题：谁来帮助那个既不能骑车、不能开车、也不能乘船的人？“车辆是一间有门的房间，”教练说，“而门是一个问题。”尽管如此，屋里没有人能回答它，而受影响那个人的声音根本不在屋里。

一位年轻的宇航员、一位敏捷的马戏团演员，以及一位在货轮上工作的水手都填了同一份表格。4路公交车的刹车、道口的开关，以及海关印章上那只鹰，是唯一有人拍下来的东西。

出国航行被推迟了，而在整个冬天里他们一起重写了整个案子。“我加入这场运动，”曼雅说，“我把代价一起带来。”说到底，这是一个外来的想法：港口属于穿越它的人；也是一个非常本土的想法：应当先问他们。本地那片区域、旅馆外的街道，以及穿越这件事本身的文化，都没有出现在任何报告里。“通勤不是旅行，”承运人说，“而民族主义不是一张时刻表。”一份出口许可证、一位带着三个孩子的家长、一辆锁在路灯柱上的自行车：委员会一张也没有拍下来。“最好的证据就是没人想要的那种证据，”艾莎说，而他们把它写了下来。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
area 'eəriə POS: n	n. 区域, 面积, 范围, 空地; [计] 区域 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a particular geographical region of indefinite boundary (usually serving some special purpose or distinguishing...)
local 'ləukəl POS: a	a. 地方性的, 当地的, 局部的, 乡土, 本地的; n. 当地居民, 本地新闻, 局部; [计] 本地的; 局部 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. public transport consisting of a bus or train that stops at all stations or stops; a. relating to or applying...
car kɑ: POS: n	n. 汽车, 客车; [机] 车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a motor vehicle with four wheels; usually propelled by an internal combustion engine; n. a wheeled vehicle...
road rəud POS: n	n. 路, 道路, 公路, 途径, 方法; [法] 公路, 道路, 行车道 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an open way (generally public) for travel or transportation; n. a way or means to achieve something
door dɔ: POS: n	n. 门 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a swinging or sliding barrier that will close the entrance to a room or building or vehicle; n. anything pr...
street stri:t POS: n	n. 街道, 马路, 街区; a. 街道的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a thoroughfare (usually including sidewalks) that is lined with buildings; n. the part of a thoroughfare be...
international .intə'næʃənəl POS: a	a. 国际的; n. 国别设定; [计] 国别设定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of several international socialist organizations; a. concerning or belonging to all or at least two or...
stage steɪdʒ POS: n	n. 阶段, 舞台, 场所, 戏剧, 站, 驿站, 级, 层, 脚手架; vt. 上演, 表演, 筹划; vi. 适于上演, 乘驿车旅行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large platform on which people can stand and can be seen by an audience; n. the theater as a profession (...)
culture 'kʌltʃə POS: n	n. 文化, 修养, 耕种; vt. 耕种, 培养 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a particular society at a particular time and place; n. the tastes in art and manners that are favored by a...
foreign 'fɔ:rin POS: a	a. 外国的, 外交的, 外省的, 外来的, 不相关的; [机] 外来的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of concern to or concerning the affairs of other nations (other than your own); a. relating to or originating...
campaign kæm'peɪn POS: n	n. 战役, 运动, 竞选运动; vi. 参加运动, 作战 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a series of actions advancing a principle or tending toward a particular end; n. several related operations...
hotel həu'tel POS: n	n. 旅馆, 客栈 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a building where travelers can pay for lodging and meals and other services
express ɪk'spres POS: n	n. 快车, 快递, 专使; a. 明确的, 丝毫不差的, 专门的, 快的; vt. 表达, 表示, 表露 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. mail that is distributed by a rapid and efficient system; n. public transport consisting of a fast train or...
coach kəuʃ POS: n	n. 四轮大马车, 教练; vt. 训练, 指导; vi. 坐马车旅行, 作指导 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (sports) someone in charge of training an athlete or a team; n. a person who gives private instruction (as...
travel 'trævl POS: n	n. 旅行, 游历, 行进; vi. 旅行, 行进, 移动, 被传播; vt. 旅行, 通过, 使移动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of going from one place to another; v. change location; move, travel, or proceed, also metaphorical...
camp kæmp POS: n	n. 露营, 帐篷; vi. 露营, 扎营; vt. 使扎营 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. temporary living quarters specially built by the army for soldiers; n. a group of people living together in...
ship ʃɪp POS: n	n. 船, 舰; vt. 以船运送, 装船, 运送; vi. 上船, 乘船 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a vessel that carries passengers or freight; v. hire for work on a ship; v. travel by ship; v. place on board...
ride raɪd POS: n	n. 骑马, 乘坐, 乘车, 搭便车; vt. 骑, 乘坐, 压迫, 控制; vi. 骑马, 乘车, 漂游 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mechanical device that you ride for amusement or excitement; v. sit and travel on the back of animal, usu...
vehicle 'vi:ɪkl POS: n	n. 交通工具, 车辆, 传播媒介; [化] 载体; 运载体; 漆料 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a conveyance that transports people or objects; n. a medium for the expression or achievement of something; ...
traffic 'træfɪk POS: n	n. 交通, 通行, 运输, 交通量, 贸易, 交易, 交往, 通信量; vi. 交易, 做买卖; vt. 用...作交换; [计] 通信量, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the aggregation of things (pedestrians or vehicles) coming and going in a particular locality during a spe...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
appointment ə'pɔɪntmənt POS: n	n. 约会, 委任的职位, 委派; [经] 任命, 派, 指定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of putting a person into a non-elective position; n. (usually plural) furnishings and equipment (es...
ticket 'tɪkɪt POS: n	n. 票, 券, 车票, 标签, 入场券, 证明书; vt. 加标签于, 为...购票 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a commercial document showing that the holder is entitled to something (as to ride on public transportatio...
journey 'dʒɜːni POS: n	n. 旅程, 旅行, 行程; vi. 旅行; vt. 游历 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of traveling from one place to another
chain tʃeɪn POS: n	n. 链, 枷锁, 束缚; vt. 用铁练锁住, 束缚, 囚禁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a series of things depending on each other as if linked together; n. (chemistry) a series of linked atoms (...
switch swɪtʃ POS: n	n. 开关, 电闸, 转换, 软枝, 鞭子, 道岔; vt. 转变, 切换, 摆动, 转换, 使转轨; vi. 转换, 变换, 摆动; [计]... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. control consisting of a mechanical or electrical or electronic device for making or breaking or changing t...
mine maɪn POS: n	n. 矿, 矿藏, 地雷; vt. 挖掘, 开采, 在...布雷, 破坏; vi. 开矿, 埋设地雷; pron. 我的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. excavation in the earth from which ores and minerals are extracted; n. explosive device that explodes on co...
port pɔːt POS: n	n. 港口, 埠, 舱门, 避风港, 左舷, 炮眼, 姿势, 意义; vt. 左转舵, 持(枪); vi. 左转舵; [计] 端口, 移植 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a place (seaport or airport) where people and merchandise can enter or leave a country; n. sweet dark-red d...
export ɪk'spɔːt POS: n	n. 输出品, 输出; vt. 输出, 出口; vi. 输出物资; [计] 导出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. commodities (goods or services) sold to a foreign country; v. sell or transfer abroad; v. transfer (electron...
abroad ə'brɔːd POS: adv	adv. 往国外, 到室外, 到处; a. 往国外的, 在室外的, 广泛四散的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. in a foreign country; r. to or in a foreign country
occupation ˌɒkjʊ'peɪʃən POS: n	n. 职业, 占有, 占有期, 占领, 占领军; [经] 占有, 占用, 职业 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the principal activity in your life that you do to earn money; n. the control of a country by military forc...
universal ˌjuːni'veɪsl POS: a	a. 全世界的, 普遍的, 宇宙的, 通用的; n. 一般概念 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (linguistics) a grammatical rule (or other linguistic feature) that is found in all languages; n. (logic) a...
import ɪm'pɔːt POS: n	n. 进口货, 进口, 输入, 含义, 重要性; vt. 输入, 引入, 进口, 含...的意思, 重要; vi. 有关系; [计] 引入 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. commodities (goods or services) bought from a foreign country; n. an imported person brought from a foreign...
carrier 'kæəriə POS: n	n. 运送者, 邮递员, 带菌者; [计] 载波 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone whose employment involves carrying something; n. a self-propelled wheeled vehicle designed specific...
eagle 'iːgl POS: n	n. 鹰, 鹰状标饰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of various large keen-sighted diurnal birds of prey noted for their broad wings and strong soaring fli...
brake breɪk POS: n	n. 刹车, 阻碍, 丛林; v. 刹车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a restraint used to slow or stop a vehicle; n. any of various ferns of the genus Pteris having pinnately co...
crossing 'krɒsɪŋ POS: n	n. 横越, 横渡, 交叉点, 渡口; [经] 划线 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. traveling across; n. a point where two lines (paths or arcs etc.) intersect; n. a path (often marked) where...
aboard ə'bɔːd POS: adv	adv. 在船上, 在火车上, 在飞机上; prep. 在...之上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. on a ship, train, plane or other vehicle; r. on first or second or third base; r. side by side; r. part of a...
passport 'pæspɔːt POS: n	n. 护照, 手段, 通行证; [法] 通行证, 护照 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a document issued by a country to a citizen allowing that person to travel abroad and re-enter the home co...
nationalism 'næʃənəlɪzəm POS: n	n. 民族主义, 民族特性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the doctrine that your national culture and interests are superior to any other; n. the aspiration for nati...
astronaut 'æstrɒnɔːt POS: n	n. 太空旅行者, 宇航员; [法] 美国太空人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person trained to travel in a spacecraft
swift swɪft POS: n	n. 褐雨燕, 快速爬行的小蜥蜴, 蝙蝠蛾, 大滚筒; a. 迅速的, 快的, 敏捷的, 立刻的; adv. 迅速地, 敏捷地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. United States meat-packer who began the use of refrigerated railroad cars (1839-1903); n. an English satiri...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
circus 'sə:kəs POS: n	n. 马戏团, 马戏, 竞技场 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a travelling company of entertainers; including trained animals; n. a performance given by a traveling comp...
voyage 'vɔɪdʒ POS: n	n. 航行, 航海, 航程. 旅行, 航空; vi. 航海, 航行; vt. 航行越过, 飞过 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a journey to some distant place; v. travel on water propelled by wind or by other means
commute kə'mju:t POS: vt	vt. 交换, 折偿, 减轻; vi. 代偿, 经常乘车来往 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a regular journey of some distance to and from your place of work; v. exchange positions without a change i...
exportation ,eksɒpə:'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 输出, 出口物, 输出品, 出口; [经] 出口(货) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n commodities (goods or services) sold to a foreign country; n the commercial activity of selling and shipping...